

032. Chapter 3 Verses 19-21

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.19

तस्मादसक्तः सततं कार्यं कर्म समाचर ।
असक्तो ह्याचरन्कर्म परमाप्नोति पूरुषः ॥ 19 ॥

tasmād asaktaḥ satataṁ kāryaṁ karma samāchara
asakto hyācharan karma param āpnoti pūruṣhaḥ

tasmāt—therefore; **asaktaḥ**—without attachment; **satatam**—constantly; **kāryam**—duty; **karma**—action; **samāchara**—perform; **asaktaḥ**—unattached; **hi**—certainly; **ācharan**—performing; **karma**—work; **param**—the Supreme; **āpnoti**—attains; **pūruṣhaḥ**—a person

Therefore that work which should be done, do it well always without attachment. He who performs all the prescribed duties in a detached spirit will attain the Supreme.

VERSE 3.20

कर्मणैव हि संसिद्धिमास्थिता जनकादयः ।
लोकसंग्रहमेवापि सम्पश्यन्कर्तुमर्हसि ॥ 20 ॥

karmaṇaiva hi sansiddhim āsthitā janakādayaḥ
loka-saṅgraham evāpi sampaśhyan kartum arhasi

karmaṇā—by the performance of prescribed duties; **eva**—only; **hi**—certainly; **sansiddhim**—perfection; **āsthitāḥ**—attained; **janaka-ādayaḥ**—King Janak and other kings; **loka-saṅgraham**—for the welfare of the masses; **eva api**—only; **sampaśhyan**—considering; **kartum**—to perform; **arhasi**—you should;

King Janaka and others attained perfection by action. Even having in view the need to show the right path to the masses, you should work.

यद्यदाचरति श्रेष्ठस्तत्तदेवेतरो जनः ।
स यत्प्रमाणं कुरुते लोकस्तदनुवर्तते ॥ 21 ॥

*yad yad ācharati śhreṣṭhas tat tad evetaro janaḥ
sa yat pramāṇam kurute lokas tad anuvartate*

yat yat—whatever; **ācharati**—does; **śhreṣṭhaḥ**—the best; **tat tat**—that (alone); **eva**—certainly; **itaraḥ**—common; **janaḥ**—people; **saḥ**—they; **yat**—whichever; **pramāṇam**—standard; **kurute**—perform; **lokaḥ**—world; **tat**—that; **anuvartate**—pursues

What-so-ever a great man does, that other men do; whatever he sets up as the standard, that the world follows.